

Product Requirements Document

Title / Initiative	LinkedIn — Improve feed relevance and job-search trust for high-intent members
Date & Version	20260815 – v1.0
Product – POC	Mritunjoy Dey
Design POC	-
Tech POC	-
Marketing POC	-

Introduction

LinkedIn's core value rests on two promises: help members stay professionally informed, and help them find real opportunities. Phase 2 research surfaced two independent, high-friction failures — the home feed no longer reliably serves the “stay current” job-to-be-done, and the jobs product suffers from a deep trust deficit: ghost listings, unverifiable companies, and search tools that don't understand intent.

This PRD proposes two coordinated suites — Feed Relevance & Discovery (primary, RICE 13.5) and Job Trust & Search Precision (secondary, RICE 9) — sequenced by RICE score and shipped as one revamp release, without rebuilding the core feed ranking algorithm or the recruiter-posting workflow.

Why? (Objective)

- For LinkedIn:** Both problems are quiet failures — no complaint ticket, no churn event — that let X / Substack / Instagram capture the “stay current” job-to-be-done, and let Naukri / Indeed / Instahyre capture real search behaviour. Fixing both increases feed time-well-spent and defends the jobs marketplace, LinkedIn's highest-intent surface.
- For Members:** Faster, more trustworthy access to what matters — network and industry signal without the noise, and job listings they can evaluate and act on with confidence.

How do we measure success?

Associated goal: improve feed relevance and job-search trust for the Industry Watcher and Blocked Applicant personas, without degrading core feed or recruiter engagement.

Suite	Type	Metric	Target
1 · Feed	Key	Highlight / Bubble Engagement Rate	15% → 35% of feed sessions engage a Bubble or Highlight, within 1 quarter.
1.Feed	Key	LinkedIn AI chat	Increase chat frequency to 15% of the total duration spent on LinkedIn for feed scrolling.
1 · Feed	Secondary	External Trend-App Reliance (self-reported)	~50% → 30% of members still rely on X / Substack / Instagram, within 2 quarters.
1 · Feed	Guardrail	Core Feed Scroll Depth / Time in Feed	Should not decrease.
2 · Job Trust	Key	Search-to-Application Conversion	8% → 18% of AI-assisted searches end in a submitted application, within 1 quarter.
2 · Job Trust	Secondary	Time to First Relevant Result	~6 min → 3 min average, from search entry to first Save / Easy Apply.
2 · Job Trust	Guardrail	Recruiter Listing Volume	Should not decrease.

Who are the users

Persona 1 — The Industry Watcher (feeds Solution 1)

Opens LinkedIn out of habit to see what's happening in their field. Scrolls a lot, reads very little, and quietly switches to X, Substack or Instagram when the feed fails to surface anything niche-relevant — without ever filing a complaint.

Job to be done: "When I open LinkedIn to catch up on my field, I want to quickly surface what's actually relevant to my niche, so I can stay sharp without wading through noise."

Persona 2 — The Blocked Applicant (feeds Solution 2)

Goes straight to Jobs with clear intent, but hits blunt filters, unverifiable listings and dense JDs — and, increasingly, silence after applying. Routes tracking and trust-checking to Naukri, Instahyre, Indeed or a personal spreadsheet.

Job to be done: "When I need my next role, I want a trustworthy, low-friction path from finding a real opening to evaluating it with confidence, so I can make decisions instead of guessing."

Problems we are solving

Industry Watcher — Needs / Problems / Jobs to be done

- Need: a low-effort way to skim network + industry signal without reading the whole feed.
- Problem: the feed is optimised for broad engagement, not topical relevance — 32% of users are dissatisfied with it.
- JTBD: when I open LinkedIn, help me tell in seconds what's actually worth my time today.

Blocked Applicant — Needs / Problems / Jobs to be done

- Need: a fast way to tell a real, well-matched listing from a ghost job or a mismatch.
- Problem: listings are self-reported with no verification layer; 35%+ call this their single biggest LinkedIn problem.
- JTBD: when I'm evaluating a listing, help me trust it and understand it fast enough to decide whether to apply.

Solution 1 (Primary · RICE 13.5) — Feed Relevance & Discovery Suite

Three coordinated features replace passive scrolling with active, high-signal surfaces — without changing the core feed ranking algorithm:

- **Status Bubbles:** story-style bubbles above the feed surfacing quick updates from a member's network.
- **LinkedIn AI Topic Highlights:** subscribable, AI-curated categories (Top Pick, Tech, Finance, AI & Cloud, Design & UX) refreshed from LinkedIn's own database, blending organic curation with clearly labelled sponsored placements — a monetisable surface for companies.
- **LinkedIn AI Assistant:** a conversational assistant in Messaging that answers questions like "what happened in AI in the last 24 hours", grounded in LinkedIn's network and web data.

Other alternatives considered

- Daily / weekly digest notification — rejected: risks notification fatigue (RICE 4).
- Follow / mute weighting overhaul — rejected: users unlikely to manually tune weights at scale (RICE 1.3).
- "Focus Mode" feed toggle and community-curated trend boards — parked as moonshots; high build cost for a smaller, power-user-only audience.

Product flow

Trigger (habit / curiosity) → Feed opens, member scans Status Bubbles and AI Topic Highlights above the post stream → Optionally opens LinkedIn AI Assistant in Messaging for a direct question → Returns to normal feed browsing with the "stay current" job done in seconds, not minutes.

Prototype: <https://ai.studio/apps/d262411f-970c-48dc-b535-dad3afdcd472>

User stories & acceptance criteria

User story	Acceptance criteria
As a member, I want a quick, story-style view of my network's recent activity, so I can catch up without scrolling the full feed.	• Bubbles appear above the feed for connections/follows with a recent update. • Opening a bubble shows the update in under 2 taps. • Bubbles refresh at session start, not mid-scroll.
As a member, I want AI-curated highlights by topic, so I can scan real industry news without wading through promotional posts.	• Categories are subscribable and personalised to followed companies / topics. • Sponsored items are clearly labelled and capped as a share of each category. • Highlights refresh at least hourly and show a timestamp.
As a member, I want to ask an AI assistant what happened in my network or industry recently, so I don't have to scroll to find out.	• Assistant answers are grounded in retrieved sources with a visible citation/link. • A visible disclosure states the assistant can make mistakes. • Assistant is reachable from Messaging in one click.

Edge cases

- Member has no recent network activity → Bubbles row is hidden rather than shown empty.
- A topic category has no fresh, high-confidence AI content for the day → category is skipped rather than padded with stale items.
- User use the ai assistant for irrelevant work “Type me a code”, which shoots the token bills and also defeats the purpose of jobs to be done.
- AI Assistant has low confidence in an answer → it says so explicitly instead of presenting a guess as fact.

Solution 2 (Secondary · RICE 9) — Job Trust & Search Precision Suite

Five coordinated features increase transparency and precision using verifiable signals and AI, without requiring companies to change how they post jobs:

- **AI Intent-Based Search + Refine:** a natural-language search bar (e.g. “remote AI PM roles, \$180–250k”) with a conversational “Refine your search” follow-up.
- **Advanced Sort & Filter:** structured controls — salary, verified recruiter, easy apply, date posted — alongside AI search.
- **Company Trust Score & Verified Reviews:** aggregate rating, % would-recommend, verified employee reviews, and structured company facts (offices, industry, awards, official site).
- **AI-Generated JD Summary + “Ask about this job”:** a structured summary (pay, must-haves, skill match) atop every listing, plus a Q&A button for follow-ups.

Other alternatives considered

- Verified Recruiter badge & listing freshness — scheduled as a fast-follow once the trust-score pipeline is live (RICE 4).
- Real-time Application Status Tracker — not in this release. It scores highest on raw pain (Phase 2 PIF 15) but needs a recruiter-side workflow change, which lowers confidence and raises effort for this phase (RICE 3); scoped as the next roadmap item.

Product flow

Trigger (needs a role) → AI Intent Search + Refine narrows results → Sort & Filter add precision → Member checks Company Trust Score / Verified Reviews → Reads AI JD Summary and asks follow-ups via “Ask about this job” → Applies with confidence instead of guessing.

Prototype: <https://ai.studio/apps/d262411f-970c-48dc-b535-dad3afdc472>

User stories & acceptance criteria

User story	Acceptance criteria
As a job seeker, I want to search using natural language describing what I want, so I don't have to guess the right keywords.	• Query like “remote AI PM roles, \$180–250k” returns role-, location- and salary-matched results. • A “Refine your search” prompt lets me narrow results conversationally. • Sort & Filter remain available alongside AI search, not instead of it.
As a job seeker, I want to see a trust score and verified reviews for a company before applying, so I can judge if a listing is legitimate.	• Every listing shows an aggregate rating, % would-recommend, and company facts (offices, industry, awards, official site). • “Read Verified Employee Reviews” is reachable in one tap. • Reviews require verified employment history to post.
As a job seeker, I want a short AI summary at the top of a job description with a way to ask follow-up questions, so I can decide quickly whether to apply.	• Summary shows pay, must-haves and skill match against my profile. • “View full description” is always one tap away. • “Ask about this job” answers follow-up questions grounded in the listing.

Edge cases

- Company has no reviews yet → show “Not enough verified reviews yet” rather than a misleading blank/zero score.
- AI search query is too vague to parse intent → fall back to keyword search and surface “Refine your search” prominently.
- JD is incomplete or malformed → AI summary flags itself as “generated from a partial description.”

Tentative timeline (preliminary, TBD)

Task	Date
Leadership approval	01/09/2026
Design ready (both suites)	15/09/2026
Prototype testing complete	30/09/2026
Development starts — Suite 1 (Feed Relevance)	01/10/2026
Development starts — Suite 2 (Job Trust)	15/10/2026 (in parallel)
Beta launch (both suites)	15/12/2026

Dependencies

Open questions

- How much should Highlight engagement or Trust Score feed back into the core feed / search ranking algorithms, if at all?
- What verified-employment threshold is required before a member can post a company review?
- How is sponsored Highlight inventory priced and capped per category?

Infrastructure, budget & internal dependencies

- Infrastructure: AI summarisation / curation pipeline, company facts + verified-review store, intent-search NLP.
- Budget: LLM inference at scale; review-moderation and verification headcount. Token guardrail and optimization
- Engineering — feed surfaces, search NLP, trust-score pipeline, experimentation setup.
- Design — feed and jobs UX for both suites.
- Data Science — A/B test analysis for both suites.
- Trust & Safety — review-gaming defence, AI-answer accuracy monitoring.
- Legal / Privacy — compliance for AI use of member and company data.
- Recruiter / Company Ops — sponsored Highlight sales, Verified Recruiter program.
- Marketing & PR — launch messaging and member education.